Cogtics – Product Functions and Competitive Analysis

This document provides a comprehensive, functional-level explanation of Cogtics, benchmarked explicitly against two major competitors: TABS and Maxio. The intent is to define what Cogtics must do, what to copy, what to improve, and how to position Cogtics as a distinct and defensible product category.

1. Functional Decomposition of Cogtics

A. Data Layer

The data layer is foundational and non-negotiable. Cogtics must ingest data from multiple source systems, including CRM, billing platforms, contract tools, and optionally usage systems. Its responsibility is not just ingestion, but normalization and truth reconciliation.

Key functions include raw data pulls, schema normalization, snapshot versioning, freshness checks, gap detection, and visibility into coverage completeness per system.

B. Contract Intelligence Layer

This layer is the primary differentiator for Cogtics. Contracts are parsed not as static documents, but as executable financial logic.

The system extracts pricing models, discounts, caps, renewals, billing cadence, and exceptions. Ambiguity detection and human overrides are first-class features, not edge cases.

C. Revenue Consistency Engine

This is the core logic engine of Cogtics. It cross-validates contract terms against CRM deal data, billing invoices, and usage records.

The engine detects underbilling, overbilling, missing invoices, expired discounts, and active contracts with no revenue. Each issue carries a confidence score and lifecycle state.

D. Analytics and Monitoring

Cogtics goes beyond point-in-time audits by continuously monitoring revenue integrity. It tracks leakage trends, segments issues by customer and internal dimensions, and highlights systemic patterns rather than isolated errors.

E. Workflow and Operations

Detection alone is insufficient. Cogtics must support operational resolution via assignments, comments, evidence attachment, SLA tracking, and integrations with existing tools like Slack or Jira.

F. Trust, Governance, and Reporting

To be accepted by finance teams, Cogtics must be audit-ready. This includes immutable audit trails, historical replay, granular permissions, and exportable evidence suitable for auditors and executives.

2. What TABS Does Well

TABS excels at financial modeling and SaaS analytics. It provides high-quality cohort analysis, retention metrics, and CFO-grade reporting that builds executive trust.

However, TABS is descriptive rather than investigative. It does not understand contracts, does not detect leakage, and does not provide an operational loop for fixing issues.

3. What Maxio Does Well

Maxio is strong in billing execution and revenue recognition. It processes invoices, ensures compliance, and handles payment workflows reliably.

Its limitation is scope. Maxio assumes upstream data is correct and does not question it. There is no cross-system verification, no forensic analysis, and no contract intelligence.

4. What Cogtics Steals, Improves, and Avoids

What to Steal from TABS

Cogtics should adopt finance-grade metrics, cohort modeling concepts, and executive-ready dashboards to gain immediate CFO credibility.

What to Improve on TABS

Cogtics replaces static analytics with active detection, adds contract intelligence, and introduces workflows to close the loop.

What to Steal from Maxio

Cogtics should leverage standard billing schemas, rev-rec logic familiarity, and proven integration patterns to reduce adoption friction.

What to Improve on Maxio

Cogtics sits above billing systems, validating correctness rather than executing billing. It adds investigation, cross-system truth, AI-driven detection, and explainability.

What to Avoid

Cogtics should avoid becoming a billing processor, generic BI tool, or simple contract repository. Its power lies in cross-system intelligence.

5. Strategic Positioning

Cogtics is best positioned as a Revenue Integrity Platform. It answers a question neither TABS nor Maxio can answer: Where do your systems disagree, why, and how much is it costing you?

6. Features That Create a Competitive Moat

Key differentiators include clause-level explainability, proof-based mismatch views, revenue risk scoring, leakage heatmaps by internal dimensions, and detection of silent, non-obvious leakage.

7. Non-Negotiable Execution Principles

To win against established competitors, Cogtics must excel at evidence clarity, false-positive control, workflow integration, financial trustworthiness, and actionable outcomes.